

Canadian Mortgage Renewal Checklist

2026 Edition · Prepared by MortgageRenewalHub.ca

Use this checklist to move through your Canadian mortgage renewal methodically. Each section maps to a 30-day window before your maturity date. Don't skip the first section — starting early is the single biggest factor in getting a great rate.

Key facts (April 2026)

Bank of Canada overnight rate: 2.25% · Prime rate: 4.45% · Next BoC decision: April 29, 2026

Best broker 5-year fixed (insured): ~3.94–4.04% · 5-year variable: ~3.30–3.35%

Stress test is waived for uninsured straight-switch renewals (OSFI, Nov 21, 2024).

30-year amortization available for all first-time buyers of insured mortgages (Dec 15, 2024).

6 Months Before Maturity — Gather Information

Know your current mortgage

- ☐ Locate your most recent mortgage statement
- ☐ Confirm your exact maturity (renewal) date
- ☐ Note your current balance, rate, amortization, and term
- ☐ Identify your charge type — standard or collateral? (affects switching cost)
- ☐ Note your lender's prepayment privileges (lump sum % and payment increase %)

Understand your context

- ☐ Review your credit score (Equifax or TransUnion — free via your bank)
- ☐ Check your current home value (HPI estimate, recent comparable sales)
- ☐ List any household income changes since your original mortgage
- ☐ Review outstanding debts that could be consolidated at renewal

4–5 Months Before Maturity — Compare Options

Shop the market

- ☐ Contact a licensed mortgage broker (free — paid by the lender, not you)
- ☐ Request quotes from at least 3 lenders: bank, monoline, credit union
- ☐ Compare rates AND terms (prepayment, penalty, portability, skip-a-payment)
- ☐ Review fixed vs. variable options against your risk tolerance
- ☐ Decide on your target term (1, 2, 3, 4, 5, or 10 years)

Run the numbers

- ☐ Calculate new payment at offered rate (use MortgageRenewalHub.ca calculator)
- ☐ Compare blend-and-extend vs. break-and-switch if your bank offers a blend
- ☐ Run a switch-vs-stay break-even including any discharge/legal/appraisal fees
- ☐ If considering equity access, compare HELOC vs. cash-out refinance

Understand what changed

- ☐ Confirm you qualify as a straight switch (same balance, same amortization)
- ☐ If straight switch: no stress test required (OSFI exemption, November 2024)
- ☐ If refinance or more money: stress test applies (contract rate + 2% or 5.25%)

3–4 Months Before Maturity — Lock Your Strategy

Get a rate hold

- ☐ Ask your broker to lock a rate hold (Canadian lenders hold up to 120 days)
- ☐ Get the commitment letter in writing with full terms
- ☐ Confirm which lender will cover which switching costs (legal, appraisal, discharge)

Negotiate with your current lender

- ☐ Present the competing offer to your current lender
- ☐ Ask them to match or beat — they often will
- ☐ Compare the matched offer against the competitor on full terms, not just rate
- ☐ Decide: stay or switch (if difference under 0.10%, staying is often easier)

Gather documents (if switching)

- ☐ Recent mortgage statement
- ☐ Proof of income (recent pay stubs, 2-year NOAs if self-employed)
- ☐ Valid government photo ID
- ☐ Most recent property tax bill
- ☐ Property insurance certificate
- ☐ Condo/strata documents (if applicable)

1–2 Months Before Maturity — Execute

If switching lenders

- ☐ Sign the new lender's commitment letter
- ☐ Complete legal work with the new lender's lawyer or title insurance provider
- ☐ Confirm the payout amount with your current lender (including any partial interest)
- ☐ Transfer pre-authorized payments to the new lender's account details

If staying with your lender

- ☐ Review and sign the renewal agreement
- ☐ Confirm the new rate, term, and amortization match what was negotiated
- ☐ Set up any new prepayment plan (accelerated bi-weekly saves ~3 yrs on a 25-yr amort)

Set up going forward

- ☐ Update your mortgage tracking spreadsheet with new rate and term
- ☐ Set a calendar reminder 12 months before the next maturity date
- ☐ Consider property tax and insurance payment changes if switching lenders
- ☐ Keep a copy of your new mortgage agreement and commitment letter

Red Flags — Stop and Ask Questions

- You were told you need to re-qualify under a stress test for a straight switch (check OSFI Nov 2024 exemption).
- The renewal offer is higher than the original posted rate even though the market has moved down.
- Legal fees over \$1,500 on a straight-charge switch (most lenders cover \$700–\$1,200 in legal).
- IRD penalty quoted over 3% of your balance with more than 2 years remaining (ask for the formula).
- Pressure to sign immediately without time to review or compare (you have 21 days to renegotiate under the Canadian Mortgage Charter).
- You were told a collateral charge is 'the same' as a standard charge (it is not — collateral cannot be assigned).

Quick Glossary

Straight switch: Moving your mortgage to a new lender with the same balance, amortization, and no new money. No stress test required since Nov 2024.

Stress test / MQR: OSFI B-20 minimum qualifying rate = greater of contract rate + 2% or 5.25%. Applies to refinances and non-straight-switch scenarios.

IRD: Interest Rate Differential — a prepayment penalty tied to the difference between your rate and today's comparable rate. Big 6 inflate this using posted rates.

Blend-and-extend: A way to lock in a lower rate early by blending your current rate with today's rate, weighted by months remaining. Big-6 bank product.

Prepayment privileges: Annual lump-sum % (typically 10–20%) and payment-increase % you can use without penalty. Use-it-or-lose-it per year.

Rate hold: A lender's commitment to honour today's rate for up to 120 days before your maturity date. Lock one while you shop.

Need help running the numbers?

A licensed mortgage broker is free to use — paid by the lender, not you. They compare 30+ Canadian lenders at once, confirm your charge type, run the switch-vs-stay math with real penalty numbers, and lock rate holds on your behalf.

Book a free renewal strategy call:

<https://mortgagerenewalhub.ca/book-a-call/>

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MortgageRenewalHub.ca · Canada's most comprehensive mortgage renewal resource
Content updated May 21, 2026. Rate data changes weekly — check the site for current rates.

Sources cited in the online guide: OSFI Guideline B-20, Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation (CMHC), Financial Consumer Agency of Canada (FCAC), Bank of Canada, Department of Finance Canada.

Educational content only. Confirm all figures with a licensed broker or lender before acting.